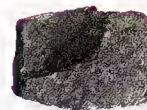


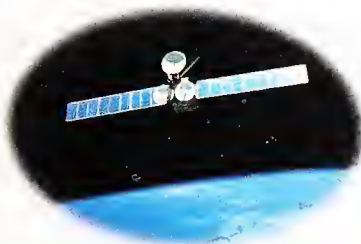


Earth

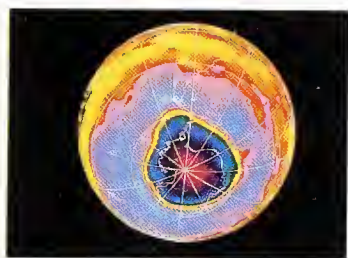


The atmosphere

The atmosphere is made up of several different layers.



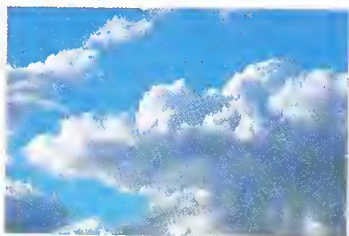
The highest layer is 430 miles (700 km) above the Earth. Satellites fly here.



The ozone layer contains ozone gas, which protects Earth from the Sun's rays.



The middle layer is up to 30 miles (50 km) high. Planes fly here, above the clouds.

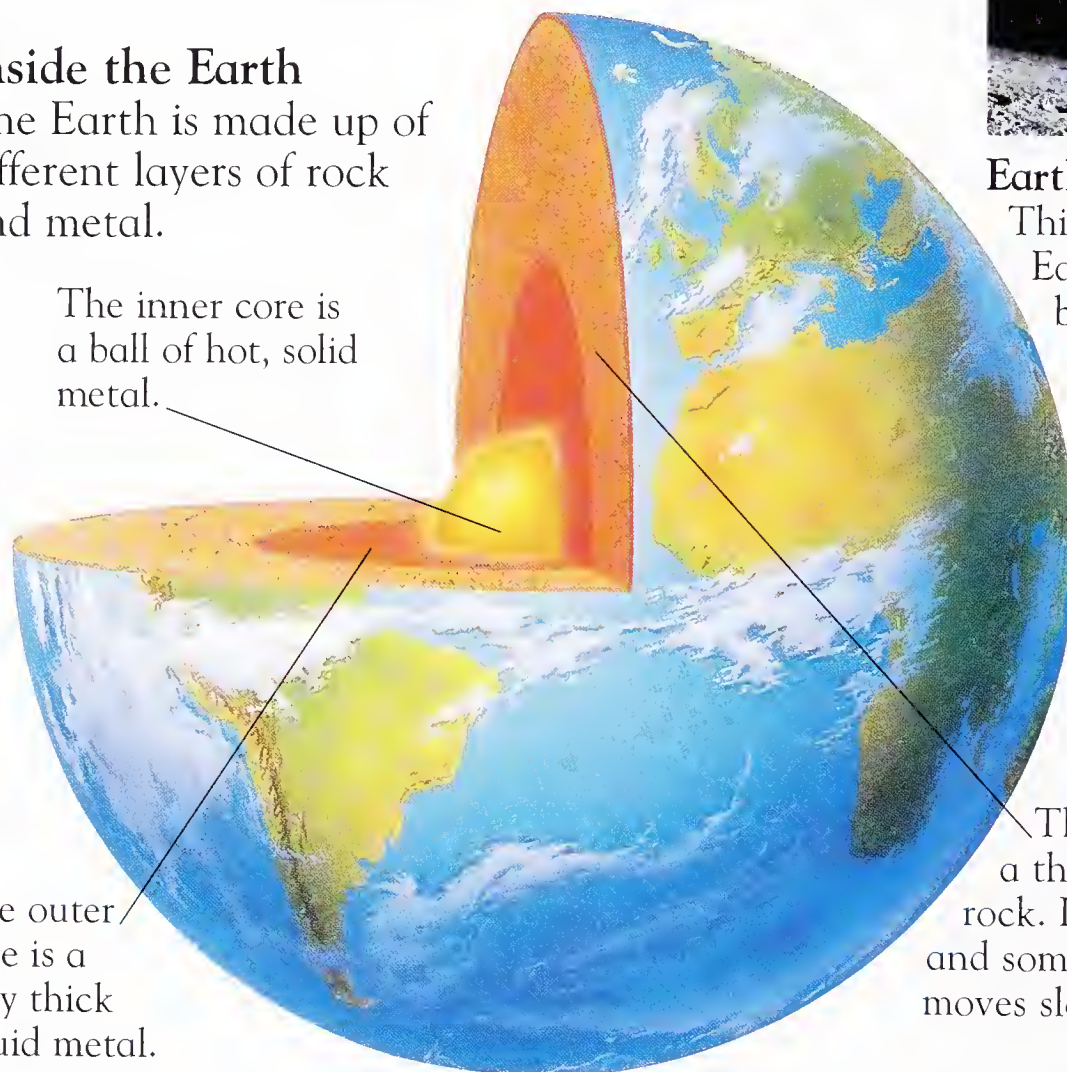


The lowest layer is only 7 miles (10 km) high. It contains the gases we need to live.

The Earth is a giant rocky ball spinning in space. It is surrounded by the atmosphere – layers of air that protect the planet and provide the oxygen we need to breathe.

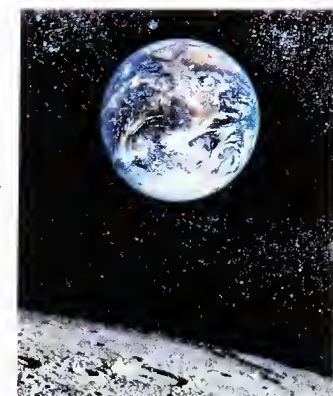
Inside the Earth

The Earth is made up of different layers of rock and metal.



The inner core is a ball of hot, solid metal.

The outer core is a very thick liquid metal.



Earth from space

This picture of Earth was taken by a camera on board a spacecraft.

The crust is the rocky layer on which we live.

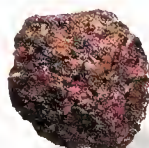
The mantle is a thick layer of rock. It is very hot and some of it moves slowly.

Earth's ingredients

The **crust** is made up of basalt and granite.



Basalt



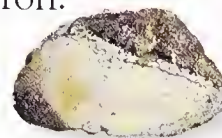
Granite

The **mantle** is a mix of metals like peridotite.



Peridotite

The **core** is made of solid metals like iron.



Iron

Water and ice cover over three-quarters of the Earth's surface.



The **atmosphere** is made up of colorless gases that surround the Earth.

Did you know?

The Earth's crust, when compared to the whole of the Earth, is thinner than the skin of an apple.

